PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Security Engineer | SIEM/XDR, Microsoft Sentinel, Defender and KQL Detection Engineering

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Security Engineer with over five years of deep, hands-on experience in Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), Extended Detection and Response (XDR), and detection engineering within complex enterprise environments. I specialise in Microsoft Sentinel, Defender XDR and Kusto Query Language (KQL), building and maintaining detection-as-code content that maps to the MITRE ATT&CK framework. At the University of the Arts London, I operate CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel at scale, designing custom detection rules, tuning alert logic and automating response workflows through Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks. I bring strong PowerShell scripting, cloud security and telemetry pipeline skills, and I am equally comfortable contributing to Managed Security Services Provider (MSSP) environments where I can deliver consistent, high-quality detection content and incident response across multiple client tenants.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM Platforms:** Microsoft Sentinel (advanced KQL, analytics rules, workbooks, playbooks), CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, Splunk/SPL, detection-as-code content development
- **XDR and EDR:** Microsoft Defender XDR (Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Defender for Identity (MDI), Defender for Office 365), CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent, Insight, Discover; alert triage and investigation
- **Detection Engineering:** Custom detection rule authoring in KQL and SPL, MITRE ATT&CK coverage mapping, alert logic validation, false-positive reduction, threat intelligence integration
- **Cloud Security and Telemetry:** Microsoft Azure (Entra ID, Conditional Access, Defender for Cloud), log ingestion pipeline design, Microsoft Sentinel data connectors and Workspace configuration
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell (advanced), KQL, SOAR playbook development (Logic Apps/Sentinel), security content automation
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 lifecycle, threat hunting, digital forensics triage, MITRE ATT&CK adversary emulation, post-incident review
- **Identity and Access:** Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access, MFA, Single Sign-On (SSO), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Email Security:** Mimecast, Microsoft Defender for Office 365, anti-phishing, DKIM/DMARC
- **Frameworks:** MITRE ATT&CK, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Operate and mature Microsoft Sentinel SIEM and CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM across an 8,000-user estate, owning the full detection engineering lifecycle from rule design to alert validation
- Author and maintain a library of custom KQL detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel, mapping each rule to MITRE ATT&CK tactics and techniques, ensuring measurable coverage across the attack surface
- Build and tune Microsoft Sentinel SOAR playbooks (Logic Apps) to automate alert triage, ticket creation and initial containment steps, reducing mean time to respond (MTTR) for Tier 1 and Tier 2 alerts
- Manage Microsoft Defender XDR platform (MDE, MDI, Defender for Office 365), investigating XDR incidents, correlating signals across endpoint, identity and email telemetry
- Design and govern log ingestion pipelines, onboarding new data sources into Microsoft Sentinel using data connectors, transformations and custom parsers
- Conduct proactive threat hunting exercises using KQL and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, identifying low-and-slow threats not surfaced by automated alerts

- Write PowerShell automation scripts for security operations tasks including account lifecycle management, compliance reporting and indicator-of-compromise (IoC) hunting
- Collaborate with infrastructure and cloud teams on Azure security posture, applying Conditional Access policies and Defender for Cloud recommendations
- Lead incident response investigations under the NIST 800-61 framework, coordinating containment, eradication and recovery with technical and business stakeholders

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity *March 2022 - March 2025*

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Performed daily SIEM alert triage and investigation in Microsoft Sentinel using KQL, escalating confirmed incidents and maintaining investigation logs
- Developed and refined Microsoft Sentinel analytics rules and watchlists, improving signal-to-noise ratio and reducing false-positive volumes by approximately 35%
- Supported CrowdStrike Falcon EDR deployment across the enterprise, configuring prevention policies, exclusions and detection logic
- Assisted in Microsoft Defender for Endpoint rollout to 8,000 devices, managing onboarding, policy compliance and alert response workflows
- Conducted threat hunting in CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Microsoft Defender, identifying and containing credential harvesting and lateral movement attempts
- Automated repetitive security operations tasks using PowerShell, including bulk account remediation and log parsing for incident investigations
- Participated in MITRE ATT&CK-mapped tabletop exercises and contributed to detection gap analysis reports

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure *February 2021 - March 2022*

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

- Configured and maintained Microsoft Defender for Endpoint and Azure Active Directory (now Entra ID) SIEM alerting for a cloud-first SaaS platform
- Developed PowerShell automation scripts for security monitoring, patch compliance and log collection to support SOC 2 Type II audit requirements
- Performed infrastructure vulnerability assessments and contributed to remediation tracking against CIS Controls and ISO 27001 frameworks
- Supported integration of cloud telemetry sources into centralised logging, enabling improved visibility across Azure-hosted services

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Built a library of 40+ custom Microsoft Sentinel detection rules in KQL, achieving measurable MITRE ATT&CK coverage across initial access, persistence, lateral movement and exfiltration tactic categories
- Designed and deployed Sentinel SOAR playbooks automating phishing remediation and account lockdown, reducing manual analyst effort by approximately 8 hours per week
- Led CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM onboarding and tuning project at UAL, improving high-severity alert fidelity by consolidating duplicate detections and enriching alerts with identity context
- Conducted threat hunt that identified a dormant credential-access campaign across 15 endpoints, enabling full containment before lateral movement occurred
- Directed Cyber Essentials Plus recertification at UAL, coordinating control evidence across SIEM, EDR, identity and device management workstreams
- Automated monthly vulnerability reporting pipeline using PowerShell and Sentinel workbooks, cutting report production time from 6 hours to under 30 minutes

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)

- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid (London/UK)